

MANAGING INSTAGRAM

Instagram may be beautiful, but managing your brand's image on it goes far beyond clicking that perfect picture. Find out the dos and don'ts of social media management on Instagram.

Instagram as a marketing platform

As of January 2016, Instagram, had a user base of 400 million according to Facebook's Community Update in January 2016. While that may still lag far behind its bigger cousins – Messenger, WhatsApp, and Facebook itself – none of them is geared towards content generation and publishing as much as Instagram. Its USP lies in making photos and videos (and their captions) the center of attraction. This allows for particularly powerful storytelling at times, with accounts such as National Geographic Travel (@natgeotravel) bringing out images from various parts of the world accompanied by unique back-stories as context for each image.

This storytelling imperative lies at the heart of exercising Instagram's marketing potential. After all, everyone loves a good story, and if that story is accompanied by a picture – be it evocative or provocative – even better. The absence of a “share” or a “re-post” feature is another